

Canada Study Visa

- CANADA.... Study permit
- You need a provincial attestation letter (PAL) or territorial attestation letter (TAL) to apply for a study permit
- Most students must include with their study permit application a PAL/TAL from the province or territory where they plan to study.
- In most cases, if you apply without a PAL/TAL, your application will be returned with fees.
- Study permit: Get the right documents
- Provincial attestation letter or territorial attestation letter
- A provincial attestation letter (PAL) or a territorial attestation letter (TAL) is a letter provided by the province or territory where you plan to study. It confirms that you' ve been assigned one of the available spaces to study in that province or territory. Most study permit applicants need to provide a PAL or TAL when they apply, unless they meet one of the exceptions.
- Who needs a PAL/TAL
- Unless you meet one of the exceptions, you must submit a PAL/TAL
- with your application, not after
- when you apply for a prerequisite course or program
- This includes language courses or programs.
- for each study permit applicant, even if you're applying as a family and submitting your applications together
- Getting your PAL/TAL
- Contact your school to find out how to apply for a PAL/TAL. Once you have one, you can apply for a study permit.
- If you're applying to a school in Quebec, follow the instructions below.
- How long a PAL or TAL is valid
- Unless it has an expiry date on it, it's valid
- until December 31, 2025, for the 2025 study permit cap year
- This means that your PAL or TAL was issued between January 22, 2025, and December 31, 2025.
- until December 31, 2026, for the 2026 study permit cap year
- This means that your PAL or TAL was issued between January 1, 2026, and December 31, 2026.
- Your PAL or TAL needs to be valid when you apply. You can't use a PAL or TAL that was issued during a previous study permit cap year.
- When to get a new PAL/TAL
- You can reapply with the same PAL/TAL if
- your PAL/TAL is still valid, and
- your study permit application was accepted for processing and you voluntarily withdrew your application before a final decision was made, or
- your study permit application was not accepted for processing

- This means that your fee was refunded and you were told that your application was not processed.
- You must get a new PAL/TAL before you reapply if
- your PAL/TAL has expired or is no longer valid, or
- your previous study permit application was approved or refused, or
- you're changing schools, or
- you're changing your level of study
- This means you're moving from
- the post-secondary level to the graduate level, or
- the graduate level to the post-secondary level
- If you're reapplying to study in Quebec, find out if you need to renew your authorizations.
- Studying in Quebec
- Quebec Acceptance Certificate
- If you want to study in Quebec, you need an attestation of issuance of your Quebec Acceptance Certificate (Certificat d'acceptation du Québec [CAQ]), which is issued by the Government of Quebec. Contact your school to find out how to apply for the CAQ.
- Who needs a CAQ
- Most students who don't need a PAL or TAL and want to study in Quebec must still get a CAQ. There are very few exceptions.
- Make sure your CAQ is valid when you apply
- A CAQ received before January 22, 2025, will be accepted for the 2025 study permit cap year if it is valid when you apply.
- Your CAQ needs to include the following line :
- "This attestation letter confirms that the applicant has a place in Quebec's share of the distribution of study permit applications or is exempt from it."
- CAQs for applications received before 8:30 a.m. ET on January 22, 2024, did not require the above line.
- Re-using a CAQ
- Find out which documents you need to study in Quebec.
- Who doesn't need a PAL or TAL
- You don't need a PAL or TAL when applying for a study permit if any of the following applies to you.
- You're applying to study at a
- preschool
- primary school (including kindergarten)
- secondary school (up to grade 12)
- degree-granting graduate program at the master's or doctoral level at a public designated learning institution (DLI) Starting January 1, 2026
- school participating in the Francophone Minority Communities Student Pilot (FMCSP) and you have a letter of acceptance from this school identifying you as an applicant under the FMCSP
- federally designated military college or

- school in Quebec in a vocational training program that leads to one of the following:
- a diploma of vocational studies (DVS)
- an attestation of vocational specialization (AVS)
- a skills training certificate (STC)
- You're an exchange student studying under an exchange arrangement between your home institution and a DLI in Canada, and you don't pay tuition fees to the DLI.
- You've received a scholarship from Global Affairs Canada.
- You're in Canada or entering Canada at a port of entry and are eligible for an exemption from certain study permit requirements based on a public policy as part of a migration response to a crisis or other pressure.
- You're exempt from certain study permit requirements under the temporary measures to reunite families of Indigenous people separated by Canada's border.
- You've entered Canada and one of the following situations applies to you:
- You're applying for a study permit extension at the same DLI and level of study as your current study permit.
- You're under a removal order, but can't be removed from Canada at this time.
- You have a temporary resident permit valid for at least 6 months.
- You're a protected person.
- You're eligible for permanent residence
- based on humanitarian and compassionate grounds , or
- based on a current public policy, or
- as a spouse or common-law partner (through the spouse or common-law partner in Canada class)
- You need to provide proof that you meet one of the above exceptions if you don't provide a PAL/TAL with your study permit application.
- Proof of financial---- Study permit: Get the right documents
- Proof of financial support
- You must prove that you have enough money, without working in Canada, to pay for all the following:
- tuition fees for the course or program of studies
- living expenses for yourself and the family members who come with you while you're in Canada
- transportation to and from Canada for yourself and your accompanying family members
- How to show you meet the financial support requirements
- You must provide us with documents that prove you have the required funds available for all the costs listed above. This means that
- you must show you have enough financial resources for the first year of your studies
- for programs more than a year long, you must also tell us how you plan to pay for the full duration of your studies
- For example: You can show proof that your scholarship is more than a year long, proof that your parents are employed, etc.
- The documents below are examples of common proofs of funds you can use.

- It's not a complete list. There may be other types of documents you can provide as proof instead.
- You don't need to provide all of these documents to show you meet the financial support requirements.
- Common documents that can be used to show proof of funds:
 - proof you paid for the first year of your tuition and housing fees
 - This must be accompanied by other documents proving you have sufficient funds to cover living expenses and transportation costs.
 - proof of a Canadian bank account in your name, if you've transferred money to Canada
 - a guaranteed investment certificate from a participating Canadian financial institution
 - proof of a student or education loan from a bank
 - your bank statements (for your Canadian or foreign bank account) for the past 4 months
 - a bank draft that can be converted to Canadian dollars
 - a letter from the person or institution giving you money
 - This must be accompanied by other documents showing proof of funds.
 - proof of financial support within Canada, if you have a scholarship or are in a Canadian-funded educational program
- Other documents may also be required. Check the visa office instructions for your country or region for local requirements.
- If your country uses foreign exchange controls, you must prove that you'll be allowed to export funds for all of your expenses.
- How much money you need for living expenses
 - This chart tells you how much money you will need to support yourself and your family members in Canada for the first year of your program of studies. These amounts are updated each year.
 - These amounts do not include tuition and transportation costs.
- If you apply on or after September 1, 2025
 - All provinces and territories except Quebec
 - Example: If you and 2 family members want to come to a province or territory (other than Quebec) for a year, you'll need \$35,040 for living expenses.
 - If you apply between January 1, 2024, and August 31, 2025 (inclusively)
 - All provinces and territories except Quebec
 - Example: If you and 2 family members want to come to a province or territory (other than Quebec) for a year, you'll need \$31,583 for living expenses.
 - Quebec
 - To obtain a Quebec Acceptance Certificate (Certificat d'acceptation du Québec [CAQ]) and study in Quebec, applicants must show they can financially cover the costs outlined by the Ministère de l'Immigration, de la Francisation et de l'Intégration.
- Study permit
- How to apply
 - The Canada Post labour disruption will cause delays in mail delivery
 - We're still processing applications normally. However, there will be delays in

- sending applications mailed within or to Canada
- getting mail from us
- We encourage you to apply online if possible. If you need to apply on paper, use another courier to send us your application.
- Generally, you must apply for a study permit before you come to Canada. Some people can apply for a study permit from within Canada. In some cases, you can apply when you arrive in Canada at the port of entry. Make sure you understand which option is available to you.
- Get your documents ready
- When you apply, you should submit
 - the letter of acceptance from the designated learning institution (DLI) you'll be attending
 - a provincial attestation letter (PAL) or territorial attestation letter (TAL)
- You can upload your PAL/TAL into the Provincial attestation letter (required) field in your application. If this option is missing, you must upload your PAL/TAL to the Client information field. If you meet an exception, you must provide any evidence in the Client information field.
- as many of the documents needed for a complete application as possible
- We won't be able to finalize your study permit until you've submitted a complete application.
- Waiting to submit documents will cause delays in processing.
- Apply online
- If you're applying for a study permit, you must apply online, whether you're outside of Canada or already in Canada.
- You're only eligible to apply on paper if you
 - have a disability that prevents you from applying online
 - hold an identity or travel document for non-national residents, refugees or stateless persons
- In Canada study permit applicants: New rules about applying at a port of entry
- Most foreign nationals already in Canada can no longer apply for a study permit at a port of entry. You must apply online for
 - your initial study permit
 - your study permit extension
- If you're outside of Canada, you may still be eligible to apply for a study permit when you arrive at a port of entry.
- If you're in Canada and leave as a student on maintained status, you'll lose your ability to study when you return. This means you can't study until your application is approved.
- Doctoral degree students: Get faster processing
- Doctoral (PhD) students and their accompanying family members may be able to get faster processing on their applications.
- Getting your application processed faster means you can start studying in Canada sooner.
- On this page
- Who's eligible
- Eligible family members
- How to get your application processed faster
- Get your documents ready

- Get certified translations
- Submit a complete application
- Give your biometrics within 2 weeks
- Faster processing for your family members
- Processing times
- Who's eligible
- You can get faster processing if you
 - are enrolling in a doctoral degree program
 - apply for a study permit from outside Canada, and
 - submit your application online
- Eligible family members
 - Family members who apply to come to Canada with you can also get faster processing if they
 - apply for a
 - visitor visa
 - work permit, or
 - study permit
 - are included in your study permit application
 - submit their application together with yours
- Eligible family members include your
 - spouse or common-law partner
 - dependent child (yours, your spouse's or your common-law partner's) or
 - dependent child of a dependent child
- Who's not eligible
 - Your application will not be processed faster if you
 - are enrolling in a master's degree program
 - are enrolling in an undergraduate degree program
 - are enrolling in a graduate diploma or certificate program
 - submit an incomplete application
 - For example, your application is missing documents.
 - have an application that is more complex
 - For example, additional security or medical screening is needed.
 - apply from within Canada
- How to get your application processed faster
 - There are some things that you need to do to avoid delays and take advantage of faster processing.
 - Get your documents ready
 - When you apply for a study permit, there are documents that you need to include with your application. Get these documents ready before you submit your application.
 - Get certified translations

- Everyone must include certified translations of documents that aren't in English or French—even if your visa office says that documents in other languages are acceptable.
- Submit a complete application
- You must submit a complete application to get faster processing. This means that when you submit your application, you must
 - include all the forms and documents listed in the document checklist
 - pay all applicable fees (including the biometrics fee if needed)
 - If you don't submit a complete application, there will be delays.
- Give your biometrics within 2 weeks of getting your biometric instruction letter
- You may need to give your biometrics after you submit your application. If you do, you must pay the biometrics fee (starting at \$85 a person) when you apply.
- If you need to give your biometrics, we'll send you a biometrics instruction letter (BIL) when we check that your application is complete.
- Your BIL will have instructions on how to make an appointment to give your biometrics. You must bring your BIL with you to your appointment.
- To get faster processing, you must give your biometrics within 2 weeks of getting your BIL.
- If you gave your biometrics in the past
 - If your biometrics are still valid, you don't need to give them again.
 - However, if your biometrics are going to expire soon, you should pay the fee when you apply and give your biometrics again.
- We can't issue a visa or permit past the expiry date of your biometrics.
- Faster processing for your family members
 - Your eligible family members also need to follow the instructions above to take advantage of faster processing. They need to
 - get their documents ready
 - The documents they need to prepare will depend on what they're applying for.
 - get certified translations (if needed)
 - submit a complete application
 - give their biometrics within 2 weeks of getting their BIL (if needed)
 - be included in your study permit application
 - submit their application together with yours
- Processing times
 - Processing begins after
 - we check that your application is complete
 - you give your biometrics
 - your designated learning institution (DLI) confirms that your letter of acceptance (LOA) is valid
 - This can take up to 10 calendar days.
 - After your DLI verifies your LOA, we aim to process your application within 2 weeks.
- Things that will delay processing
 - You won't get faster processing if

- your application is incomplete
- you don't give your biometrics on time
- your application is more complex because of additional medical or security screening
- your DLI doesn't verify your LOA on time
- While your application is being processed, we'll only contact you if
- you're missing documents
- If you're missing documents, you won't get faster processing.
- we made a decision on your application
- Contacting us will not speed up the processing of your application.
- Study permit
- Get the right documents
- To apply for a study permit, there are some documents you need to include. In some cases, you may not need all of them. Make sure you know what applies to your situation.
- 1
- Get your letter of acceptance Always required
- Your school will give you a letter of acceptance. Upload this to your online application.
- Post-secondary students
- Your school will be asked to make sure your letter of acceptance (LOA) is valid.
- If your school does not respond by the deadline, we'll return your application and refund your processing fee. Confirm with your school that they will validate your LOA before resubmitting your application.
- Only attach your LOA in the LOA-specific space when uploading documents for your online application.
- If you attach other documents in this space, you're giving your consent to disclose these additional documents to your school. All other required documents should be attached in the corresponding spaces in your online application.
- Exceptions
- If you're the family member of someone who has a study permit or work permit application that's been approved in writing before you come to Canada, you don't need a letter of acceptance.
- 2
- Apply for a provincial or territorial attestation letter Needed in most cases
- Get a provincial or territorial attestation letter (PAL/TAL) from your school. In most cases, you need to accept your offer and pay your tuition fees, either in part or in full, to get your PAL/TAL.
- If you're studying in Quebec, you need a Quebec Acceptance Certificate (Certificat d'acceptation du Québec [CAQ]).
- 3
- Show proof of identity Always required
- To show proof of identity, you (and each family member who comes with you) must have
- a copy of a valid passport or travel document
- Upload a copy of the information page of your passport when you apply online.

- If you're approved, you must send us your original passport.
- 2 recent passport size photos
- The name and date of birth of the person must be written on the back of each photo.
- You must explain why you want to study in Canada, and that you understand your responsibilities as an international student in Canada.
- 6
- Get a medical exam Check if needed
- You may need a medical exam if any of these situations apply to you:
- You plan to stay in Canada for more than 6 months.
- You recently spent time in certain countries.
- You plan to work in certain jobs where public health must be protected.
- Check if you need a medical exam.
- 7
- Get a police certificate Check if needed
- In some cases, we may ask you for a police certificate. If you think you might need one, you should apply for one as early as possible.
- 8
- Proof of care (for minor children in Canada) Check if needed
- Children under the age of 17 who are not coming to Canada with a parent or legal guardian must have an appointed custodian.
- Find out what you need to submit for children under the age of 17.
- 9
- Check for other documents you might need based on what country you're applying from Check if needed
- There may be other documents to submit that are specific to your local visa office. To get your local visa office instructions:
- Go to the How to apply page
- Select "Outside Canada"
- Select "Apply online"
- Select your country or territory from the list.
- If you aren't currently in your home country, you may have to prove your immigration status in the country you apply from.
- If the government that issued your passport or travel document needs you to have a re-entry permit, you must get one before you apply for a Canadian visa. You may also need other documents.
- Eligibility requirements
- You can come to Canada to study if you
- are enrolled at a DLI
- prove you have enough money to pay for
- your tuition fees
- living expenses for yourself and any family members who come with you to Canada and

- return transportation for yourself and any family members who come with you to Canada
- obey the law, have no criminal record and get a police certificate (if required)
- are in good health and get a medical exam (if required) and
- prove to an officer that you will leave Canada when your study permit expires
- Your responsibilities as a student
- While studying in Canada you must
- make progress towards completing your program
- respect any conditions listed on your study permit
- stop studying if you no longer meet the requirements
- Depending on your case, there may be conditions on your study permit such as
- if you're allowed to work in Canada
- the specific date you must leave Canada
- where you can study (a specific DLI listed on your permit)
- You need to follow our instructions if you want to change schools at the post-secondary level.
- whether you need an immigration medical examination
- Post-graduation work permit
- You may be able to stay and work in Canada after you graduate by getting a post-graduation work permit (PGWP). PGWP eligibility depends on several requirements, including when you submit your study permit application. If you're interested, check the requirements before you submit your study permit application.
- Check if the DLI you choose offers PGWP-eligible programs.
- Student Visa
- Overview